Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa)

Branding and Marking Requirements

3 February 2026

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BACKGROUND

The Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa) is a program funded by the United States Government that started in May 2022 to be implemented across Jordan for five years. This Branding and Marking Requirements document will be implemented and updated as needed to support program implementation and ensure raising the profile of the program and donor's contribution to the Jordanian society.

All Iqlaa implementation consortium partners (implementation consortium), contracted service providers/vendors (contractors), and sub-grantees need to comply with the branding and marking guidelines in this document in coordination with the Communications Team of Iqlaa at Mercy Corps. Not complying might result in disallowed costs.

KEY MESSAGES

Messages are closely tied to Iqlaa's objectives. This section provides a set of statements that Iqlaa's team, implementation consortium, contractors, and sub-grantees need to refer to in their communications and public speaking opportunities wherever applicable. These messages can become the underlying themes for Iqlaa's communications collateral and activities (e.g., sets of talking points in speeches and presentations, basis for advertisements, posters, and editorials) – *this is a living section that will keep getting updated.*

Iqlaa will support the promotion and delivery of key messages to advocate for MSEs in Jordan and communicate the importance of supporting them as they are the backbone of the Jordanian economy. Iqlaa will also support the donor in its key messages to promote the support for the Jordanian economy and society.

Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees need to introduce Iqlaa and establish their relation to the program in all relevant communications and visibility material.

- **Key Message 1: Context.**
    - The private sector in Jordan is characterized by the predominance of micro and small enterprises (MSEs) that form 98 percent of the country's businesses. Nevertheless, MSEs have limited ability to access markets and appropriate funding to meet their business growth and resilience needs.
    - MSEs are an essential driver of employment and economic stability in Jordan. They employ approximately 60 percent of the country's private sector workforce and contribute half of the national GDP. As such, they require urgent assistance to keep businesses afloat, as well as systems-level interventions to address longstanding barriers to MSE resilience, formalization, and growth.

- **Key Message 2**: **Recovery**. With support from the American People, Iqlaa is supporting Jordan's MSEs to meet their immediate needs towards recovery amidst long-term economic stress.
- **Key Message 3: Stability and Resilience**. Iqlaa's support will build and strengthen both informal and formal Jordanian MSE's foundations and resilience to future challenges.
- **Key Message 4**: **Growth and Transformation**. Iqlaa will support systems-level change enabling MSEs to formalize, transform and scale creating equitable opportunities and a dignified work environment for all.
    - The program supports firms to achieve productivity and expand and grow through access to markets. It also provides the tools needed to capitalize on market opportunities.
    - The program expands access to finance to allow firms to survive, grow, and reach new levels of productivity.
- **Key Message 5: Strategic Targets:**
    - Reach 11,000 MSEs in Jordan with program services and support.
    - Provide formalization support to growth-oriented informal businesses.
    - Increase sales and revenues for MSEs through access to markets and business opportunities.
    - Create business linkages for MSEs with broader value chains and larger businesses.
    - Provide MSEs with financial management services/ products and access to finance.
- **Key Message 6: Public Private Dialogue:** Iqlaa aims to enhance national commitment to evidence-based public private dialogue relevant to MSEs.
- **Key Message 7: Participation**. Iqlaa encourages and supports the participation of all MSE-owner segments.
- **Key Message 8**: **Evidence-based**. Iqlaa relies on research and analysis to ensure evidence-based activities, inform decision-making in solving challenges, and maximize buy-in and investment from Jordanian actors.
- **Key Message 9: Methodology.** Iqlaa works to implement best practices in enterprise strengthening, job creation, and financial sector development within a market-systems development (MSD) framework. The program seeks to leverage innovative behavioral change methodologies to facilitate long-term, sustainable changes in the behaviors of stakeholders and beneficiaries that align better with the current needs of Jordan's MSEs.
- **Key Message 10: Approach.** Iqlaa's approach focuses on expanding access to markets through aggregators; provision of MSE-targeted capacity building through Business Development Service Providers, accelerators, and incubators; and facilitation of innovative financial products targeting MSEs.
- **Key Message 11: Branding and Marking.** Since the USG is the sole funder of the program, Iqlaa will be focused on presenting the donor in all public communications as follows: "*Iqlaa is made possible by the generous support of the United States Government and is implemented by Mercy Corps and partners.*"

BRIEF & BOILERPLATE

The following boilerplate will be used to provide a quick brief about Iqlaa in press releases, TORs, RFAs, RFPs, and other communications collateral and announcements where applicable:

Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa), funded by the United States Government, is a program that started in May 2022 and aims to support Jordan's HBBs and MSEs to grow, transform, and become resilient to future challenges. Iqlaa's approach explores new ways of doing business and improving access to finance, markets, and services. It focuses on four sectors: agriculture, tourism and hospitality, manufacturing, and services, with a special focus on technology development and implementation. The program encourages and supports the participation of all MSE-owner segments.

Through research and adaptive collaborative learning, Iqlaa has identified opportunities, incentives, and market constraints that facilitate or restrict formalization and growth. Based on the findings, Iqlaa implements best practices in enterprise strengthening and MSE-focused financial sector development within a market systems development (MSD) framework. Iqlaa also leverages innovative behavioral change methodologies to facilitate long-term, sustainable changes in the MSEs ecosystem in Jordan.

Implementing Organizations: Mercy Corps (lead implementer), Andersen for Legal and Tax Consultancy, Dalberg Design, Expectation State, Middle East Investment Initiative (MEII), Migrate-Jordan, and American Chamber of Commerce in Jordan (AmCham).

Iqlaa Services

- **Enhancing entrepreneurial, managerial, technical, and financial skills** through capacity-building programs.
- Supporting MSE establishment and development through **incubators and accelerators**.
- **Fostering business linkages and access to markets** through aggregators and business-to-business platforms.
- **Providing guidance and business support** through business centers and business clinics.
- **Business mentorship** and guidance.
- **Enhancing access to appropriate financial services and products** by improving the capacity of financial service providers to cater to MSEs' needs.
- Providing MSEs with accounting software systems and needed training.
- **E-commerce support** for building capacity to establish and effectively manage online stores. Iqlaa also supports solutions that enrich the e-commerce ecosystem to better serve MSEs.
- Raising awareness and providing guidance on **formalization**.
- **Enhancing public-private dialogue** around priority issues faced by MSEs.

DONOR POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

Branding & Marking. As part of its communications strategy, Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees, will adhere to all branding and marking guidelines as

stipulated in **branding guidelines by the US Department of State** detailed here, and the program's approved branding and marking plan.

Iqlaa Communications Team will provide copies of notices or announcements to the donor Grants Officer Representative (GOR) in advance of releases or publishing material, as practicable.

Any "public communication" in which the content has not been approved by the donor must contain the following disclaimer:

This [specify item: report, video, website, etc] has been produced by [Partner/Subgrant] for the Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa) funded by the United States Government. All intellectual property rights related to this [specify item: report, video, website, etc] are reserved by [Partner/Subgrant and Mercy Corps]. Any unauthorized reproduction, copying, distribution, translation, or use of this [specify item: report, video, website, etc], either in whole or in part, with or without pay, for any reason, and without prior written permission from [Partner/Subgrant and Mercy Corps] is strictly prohibited.

This study/ report/ audio/ visual/ other information/ media product (specify) is made possible by the generous support of the United States Government. The contents are the responsibility of [Partner/ Subgrant and Mercy Corps] and do not necessarily reflect the views of the United States Government.

BRANDING AND MARKING REQUIREMENTS

With reference to this Branding and Marking Requirements for Assistance Awards, below is the required Branding Strategy and Marking Plan**:**

(1) POSITIONING:

Program Name: The official name of the program is:

The Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa)
برنامج تطوير إنتاجية المشاريع المتناهية الصغر والصغيرة (إقلاع)

These names should be reflected in public communications material such as reports, RFAs, RFPs, web pages, presentations, flyers, brochures, roll up banners, social media posts, etc.

*Nevertheless, for all official documents including tax exemption letters, the program name should be "**Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa**ع)" with the ع, and in Arabic* ***مشروع تطوير إنتاجية المشاريع الصغيرة والناشئة (إقلاع)*** *These names should be used in all financial and contractual documents including but not limited to invoices, contracts for staff, consultants and vendors, etc, to avoid any issues with tax authorities in the future.*

Donor Marking: Iqlaa implementation partners, contractors, and sub-grantees will use the donor identity comprised of the U.S. flag, as found on the donor's website at https://brand.america.gov/d/WrAFnKrhEEfk/multilateral-branding. Where appropriate, Iqlaa implementation partners, contractors, and sub-grantees will use the local language (Arabic)

translation of the phrase ***"made possible by (or with) the generous support of the American People"*** when acknowledging donor contributions.

Co-branding and co-marking: Iqlaa implementation consortium and sub-grantees will use co-branding and co-marking. This means that the program name represents both the donor and the implementing consortium, and the donor's identity will be visible with equal size and prominence to implementation consortium logos on materials produced for distribution to program participants or others. The donor, Mercy Corps, and partner/ sub-grantees logos will be included in materials warranting branding and marking, in coordination with the Iqlaa Communications Team.

Note: service providers/vendors contracted by Iqlaa (contractors) are not permitted to have their logos on any programmatic or communications material within the scope of the program. Nevertheless, they need to comply with the branding and marking of Iqlaa, using the donor, Mercy Corps, and implementation consortium partner's logos as applicable and as clarified in this document, in coordination with Iqlaa's Communications Team.

Desired Level of Visibility: Mercy Corps proposes a **Medium** overall level of visibility for Iqlaa. In line with our 'markets in crisis' approach, we anticipate a high level of visibility for direct interventions targeting large numbers of micro and small enterprises (MSEs), and a medium or low level of visibility for facilitative, market systems-level interventions and partnerships. Mercy Corps anticipates a high level of visibility for program-level events and communications products.

(2) PRESS AND PROMOTIONAL ACTIVITIES

The United States Government is mandated to mark its foreign assistance with the donor identity (logo). Therefore, in all USG funded and related activities, Iqlaa will consistently undertake the following steps to highlight the donor's collaboration and support:

(Note: The Informal Livelihoods Advancement Activity (Iqlaa), funded by the United States Government
and
برنامج تطوير إنتاجية المشاريع المتناهية الصغر والصغيرة (إقلاع)، الممول من حكومة الولايات المتحدة
are to be used for press and promotional activities as applicable).

A. Textually: Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors, and sub-grantees will include references to the donor support in all printed outreach and communications materials, including but not limited to reports, press releases, website content, invitations, publications, fact sheets, presentations, and promotional materials relating to the program.

Typically, at the end of press releases, Iqlaa implementation partners, contractors and sub-grantees will include an acknowledgement that the project is "funded through the U.S.-Jordan Memorandum of Understanding for economic development assistance." This statement is to be integrated into a larger statement (not just as a stand-alone sentence).

B. Verbally: Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors, and sub-grantees will ensure that the donor is publicly credited in all verbal outreach and communications activities including but not limited to speeches, press conferences, media interviews, presentations, training workshops, videos, films, public service announcements, and community meetings when referencing the program.

C. Visually: The donor and Mercy Corps' identities will be prominently displayed on all outreach and communications materials including but not limited to reports, press releases, website content, invitations, publications, fact sheets, presentations, videos, films, public service announcements, banners, and other promotional materials. The logos displayed should be of equal size and prominence. Other logos, including a separate program-specific logo, will not be used.

Where applicable, such as in documents and presentations, Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees should place the consortium logos on the cover page or slide along with the program name. As for the inside pages/slides, they will only place the donor, Mercy Corps and the implementation consortium partner/ consortium contractor's logo or sub-grantee logo. For other material, the implementing consortium partners/ consortium contractors' logos will be used as and when appropriate, provided they do not visually-clutter the material; nevertheless, the minimum requirement would be to always place the donor, Mercy Corps and the consortium partner/ consortium contractor logo.

Note: service providers/vendors contracted by Iqlaa (contractors) are not permitted to have their logos on any programmatic or communications material within the scope of the program. Nevertheless, they need to comply with the branding and marking of Iqlaa, using the donor, Mercy Corps, and implementation consortium logos as applicable and as clarified in this document, in coordination with Iqlaa's Communications Team.

D. In Media: The GOR will be notified by Mercy Corps of each high-level public event or workshop that includes USG and/or GOJ leadership and where the public media will be involved, at least four weeks in advance. With the prior approval of the GOR, host country and international press will be engaged at all possible opportunities. The donor will be acknowledged at all media events directly supported by the program and in reporting on the program. Media coverage of the work may include but is not limited to local radio, local TV, international TV, video, film, webcasts, and print (magazines, newspapers, etc.). The program will consult with the GOR as to whether the donor should grant interviews.

E. In Stories and Photos: Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors, and sub-grantees will submit to the donor at least one success story per quarter demonstrating how the program is achieving its objectives through their implemented activities, using a donor-approved story format and templates that will be provided by the Iqlaa communications team. Based on their work progress and interaction with participants, Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors, and sub-grantees need to proactively suggest potential stories for Mercy Corps and when applicable contribute to the creation of the story content. Professional, high quality captioned

digital photos will be provided for each success story and event. Noteworthy or especially interesting stories and photos will be sent to the GOR punctually.

F. In Social Media: Iqlaa's Facebook and LinkedIn pages will publish posts related to activities progress. Partners and sub-grantees can also use their own social media platforms to publish about their Iqlaa-related activities progress after obtaining approvals by the donor through Mercy Corps.

Press releases and other public communications products for release by the implementing partners and sub-grantees will be submitted to Mercy Corps for review, who will in turn submit to the donor for review and approval to ensure that they are consistent with the donor's outreach and communications policies. The program will conclude with a closeout event to celebrate relevant achievements. The timing and release of all public information will be coordinated well in advance with the GOR through Mercy Corps.

Mercy Corps will submit all communications materials prepared with the donor funding to the GOR for preproduction review and approval for branding and content before costs are incurred. All costs associated with branding and marking are included in the award budget.

4) APPROVALS

All communications material prepared by the implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees within the scope of the Iqlaa program should be run by the Iqlaa communications team at Mercy Corps for review and approval prior to any publishing, dissemination, or production.

Implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees should send communications material for review by Iqlaa and the donor a minimum of 3 weeks in advance. As for planned events, they need to allow for a minimum of 7 weeks for approvals, especially for events to which we could invite US Government representatives.

Note: partners and sub-grantees need to notify Mercy Corps – Iqlaa of any plans to invite royal family or governmental representatives to their planned events/field visits within the scope of Iqlaa, for which Iqlaa will seek donor approval. Moreover, any planned patronage invitations to royal family or governmental representatives should be approved by the donor through Mercy Corps – Iqlaa prior to taking any action in this regard. All the above should be done in coordination with the Iqlaa communications team 7 weeks in advance of the planned visits/events.

MARKING PLAN

Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees will use co-branding and co-marking on all program-related materials warranting branding or marking produced for distribution to program participants or others. The donor's identity (logo and tagline) will be placed first from the left, then Mercy Corps' logo, then partners' logos. In all cases where Iqlaa uses the donor brand identity to mark program material, this use will be in full compliance with the Multilateral Branding Guidelines published here.

Iqlaa implementation consortium, contractors and sub-grantees will mark program deliverables funded under the award as outlined in this Marking Plan.

Note: service providers/vendors contracted by Iqlaa (contractors) are not permitted to have their logos on any programmatic or communications material within the scope of the program. Nevertheless, they need to comply with the branding and marking of Iqlaa, using the donor, Mercy Corps, and implementation consortium logos as applicable and as clarified in this document, in coordination with Iqlaa's Communications Team.

(1) COMMUNICATIONS PRODUCTS:

Communications products funded under the award will be marked as follows:

Category	Marking Materials Used, Placement, and Timing
Factsheet, flyers, success stories, briefing papers, reports, etc.	• The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the top or bottom of the cover page as applicable – the donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. • Donor standard acknowledgement and disclaimer language printed at the beginning of the document/on the title page of the document with the donor logo appearing on the cover page, as noted above and on the title page.
Stand-up banners, posters, and general banners	• The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the top of the banner to allow for visibility especially when being used in crowded events where the bottom part of the banners is not visible. For posters, we need to allow for flexibility (whether on the top or bottom) – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. *(Note: this point might be changed (tbc))*
Social media posts	• Mentioning of the donor or hashtag • The donor logo on images where appropriate
Advertising on social media	• The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the advertisement – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners.
Audio or video productions, including TV or radio	• The donor and Mercy Corps' identities will be used with the electronic presentation, following the donor Multilateral Branding Guidelines or such supplemental guidance as may be provided by the donor. The identities will also be used on the USB key, etc. containing the video.

(2) EVENTS:

Events funded under the award will be marked as follows:

Category	Marking Materials Used, Placement, and Timing
Iqlaa launch event	• The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of associated flyers and banners –

	donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners.
Live promotional events and interviews covered by the media (whether live or after the fact), including radio talk shows, magazines, and call-in programs and press	● Iqlaa will share a standard statement regarding the donor's funding of the event to all print, broadcast, and online journalists covering the events and ask them to include this statement (either printed/written online or read aloud on the radio) when the products are published. ● Any associated print materials or banners will have donor, Mercy Corps and implementing partner logos printed on them – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners.
Presentations of achievements and other milestones; regular coordination meetings and partner meetings	● The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of cover page of documents and banners – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners.
Workshops and trainings	● The donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of the cover page of printed materials and banners – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners.
Public events with donor representatives and donor visitors that include visibility materials	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of associated flyers and banners – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. ● Iqlaa will share a standard statement regarding the donor funding of the event to all print, broadcast, and online journalists covering the events and ask them to include this statement (either printed/written online or read aloud on the radio) when the products are published.
Iqlaa closure/close-out	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of associated flyers and banners – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. ● Iqlaa will share a standard statement regarding donor funding of the event to all print, broadcast, and online journalists covering the events and ask them to include this statement (either printed/written online or read aloud on the radio) when the products are published.

(3) PROGRAM DELIVERABLES

Program deliverables funded under the award will be marked as follows:

Category	Marking Materials Used, Placement, and Timing

Program Reports	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of the cover page – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. ● Donor standard acknowledgement and disclaimer language printed at the beginning of the document/on the title page of the document with the donor logo appearing on the cover page, as noted above and on the title page.
Technical Reports for External Distribution	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of the cover page – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. ● Donor standard acknowledgement and disclaimer language printed at the beginning of the document/on the title page of the document with the donor logo appearing on the cover page, as noted above and on the title page.
Technical Guidelines and Manuals for External Distribution	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner logos printed on the bottom of the cover page – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners. ● Donor standard acknowledgement and disclaimer language printed at the beginning of the document/on the title page of the document with the donor logo appearing on the cover page, as noted above and on the title page.
Sub-Grant Documentation	● Donor, Mercy Corps, and implementing partner printed on cover page – donor logo first from the left, then Mercy Corps, then partners – with the design following guidelines for full branding unless co-branding is acceptable, or an exemption is provided for no branding.

(4) MARKING EXCEPTIONS

Non-deliverable Items and Items for Administrative Use

Iqlaa implementation partners and contractors are not required to mark offices, vehicles, equipment, supplies or other non-deliverable items funded under the award for their internal use in the administration of the award.

Iqlaa implementation partners and contractors' employees will not use the donor Identity on business cards or other personally identifying materials.

(5) PRE-PRODUCTION REVIEW

Iqlaa implementation partners, contractors and sub-grantees acknowledge that, through Mercy Corps, a pre-production review is required of USG-funded public communications and program materials for compliance with the approved Marking Plan. Any "public communications", as defined in 2 CFR 700.1(j), funded by USG, in which the content has not been approved by the donor, must contain the following disclaimer:

"This content is made possible by the generous support of the United States Government. The contents are the responsibility of (partner/ grantee and) Mercy Corps and do not necessarily reflect the views of the United States Government."

"هذا المحتوى بدعم كريم من حكومة الولايات المتحدة وهو من مسؤولية (الشريك/ الجهة الممنوحة وميرسي كوربس) ولا يعكس بالضرورة وجهات نظر حكومة الولايات المتحدة."

(6) SUB-RECIPIENT MARKING REQUIREMENTS

To ensure that the marking requirements "flow down" to sub-recipients of sub-awards, recipients of USG funded grants and cooperative agreements or other assistance awards will include the donor- approved marking provision in any donor funded sub-award, as follows:

"As a condition of receipt of this sub-award, marking with the donor *Identity of a size and prominence equivalent to or greater than the recipient's, sub-recipient's, other donor's or third party's is required. In the event the recipient chooses not to require marking with its own identity or logo by the sub-recipient,* donor*, at its discretion, require marking by the sub-recipient with the* donor *Identity."*